

Smartphone – Mid-ranged

So what if you don't have the money to buy a premium or high-end smartphone? ₹20k is enough money these days, with these stars!



Asus Zenfone 2 ZE551ML
Price: ₹19,999



Meizu MX5
Price: ₹19,999



Motorola Moto X Play
Price: ₹18,499

If you are buying a smartphone today in India, chances are you are buying something from the mid range category. This category which spans from ₹10,000 to ₹20,000 offers some of the best well rounded smartphones you can buy today, sporting of flagship specs, 1080p displays and improved camera performance. Here are our pick for the two top performing phones in the category.

Zero1 Winner

Asus Zenfone 2 ZE551ML

No matter how many jokes people may crack on the number of Zenfones available in the market, fact is, they are bloody good phones. Asus, which made its way last year with the Zenfone 5 in the smartphone category got a great reception and the company reciprocated that, this year, with the Zenfone 2. This phone range, and this phone in particular gave the company a firm grip over the mid-range category making it our choice for the best phone in the ₹10,000 to ₹20,000 category.

The Asus Zenfone 2 can be seen as “THE” phone which started the trend of bringing flagship class hardware to the mass consumed mid-range. Offering 4GB of RAM, 32GB of storage and powered by

a quad-core Intel processor, this phone is not just good on paper but a real performance monger. Touching almost 46,500 points in Antutu synthetic benchmarks, the Zenfone 2 falls just short from offering a flagship class performance. That said, it is quite an achievement in itself. Adding to it, the tried and tested design, gives the phone a very sturdy build which can be relied upon to soak up those accidental bumps.

Second Place

Meizu MX5

Meizu came to India this year with three new phones and all three were simply superb in their respective categories. The MX5 which is the current flagship smartphone in India for the company can easily be endorsed as the most affordable flagship phone you can buy. Meizu MX5 comes with quite a resume featuring Mediatek's best SoC - Helio X10, a full metal unibody construction and a 20MP camera to say the least. In the performance department, it is slightly slower than our winner but it comes with a better display. However, since this is Meizu, which is a Chinese smartphone company, a custom UI is somewhat, a mandatory affair on top of Android.

And, while the UI is quite user friendly, it does come with a small learning curve. So, once you get accustomed to the ‘home’ cum ‘back’ cum ‘fingerprint sensor’ button and figure out the gesture to call the multitask window, you will be able to appreciate Meizu's MX5.

Best Buy

Motorola Moto X Play

Moto X Play is the obvious choice if you want a no nonsense smartphone in the mid-range category. From the past two generations Moto X range of phones have been about the best phone Motorola has to offer, which meant leaving a considerable gap between the Moto G and the X. Now though, Motorola has dealt with the problem by offering the Moto X Play. The Play is not the fastest mid-range phone out there, nonetheless, the Qualcomm Snapdragon 615 is still a very capable SoC for most usage scenarios.

Starting from the new and much improved 21MP rear camera, which is one of the best cameras we have seen on a mid-ranged smartphone. Adding to it, the large 3630 mAh battery will be able to last you a day, any day, without asking for a quick recharge. However, the cherry on the cake is the UI experience.